Several specific examples of Lashkar recruitment are notable because they illustrate its members' integration with al-Qaeda, the Haqqani Network and the TTP, which were running camps in the Waziristan agencies to indoctrinate and train young Pakistanis to become suicide bombers. Lashkar members recruited men from the Ahl-e-Hadith mosque in the Jalozai refugee camp in Peshawar, promising they would be given training and their expenses paid in return for joining the jihad in Afghanistan. According to the accounts given to a Pakistan-based journalist by relatives of those recruited, some of the men were sent to the aforementioned camps to become suicide bombers in Afghanistan.[97] In another instance, a Lashkar operative recruited two youths from Buner in the NWFP and brought them to Muridke where they were given the option of becoming suicide bombers. He promised them two weeks of training at Muridke, after which they would be taken to Peshawar and introduced to other militants. After tribal elders intervened and brought both of them home, one of the boys explained that at Muridke, 'We were told it is our choice to become a freedom fighter or a suicide bomber. But we should never fight against Pakistan.'[98] To put these recruitment activities in perspective, suicide bombings in Afghanistan jumped from 17 in 2005 to 123 in 2006, and some of the US military reports leaked in 2010 detailed efforts by ISI officers to run networks of suicide bombers recruited from Pakistan.[99]

The bulk of Lashkar members who participated in the Afghan jihad during this time fought in and around Kunar and Nuristan provinces. A few of them had already begun turning up in the area earlier in the decade, and by 2005 the Korengal Valley in Kunar province was a place where insurgents were guaranteed combat if they wanted it. This was not strictly, or even primarily, a Lashkar front; multiple outfits were active in the area. Because the group had historical ties to Afghan Salafis there, this was the natural place for its members to engage the enemy. Others fighting there included the Afghan Taliban, local Salafis, Kashmir Khan's Hizb-e-Islami faction, Jaish-e-Mohammad, the Tehrik-e-Taliban Pakistan and Jamiat al-Dawa al-Quran wal-Sunna, which included some Arab fighters from the first Afghan jihad in its ranks. Additional Arab veterans, who had settled in Pakistan after the Soviet withdrawal, also returned to fight, while other foreign fighters and some al-Qaeda operatives appeared as well.[100] Lashkar